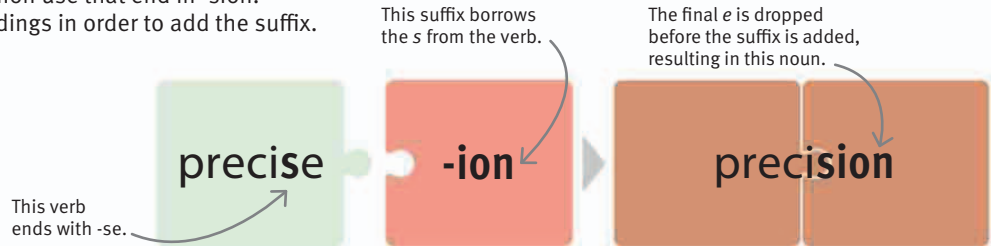


Words ending in -sion

The suffix -sion means “the state of.” For example, *conclusion* means “the state of concluding.” There are about 50 words in common use that end in -sion. Most verbs change their endings in order to add the suffix.

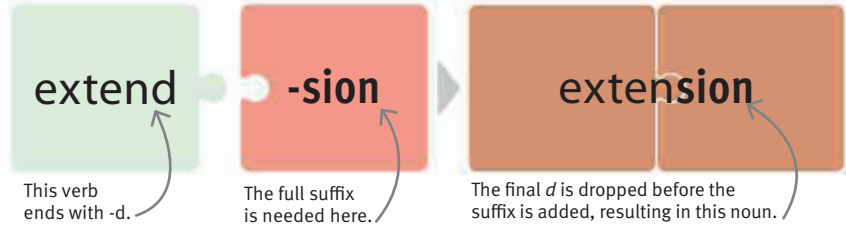
▷ Rule 1

If the verb ends in -se, then remove the e and add -ion because s is already present.



▷ Rule 2

This suffix is used when the verb ends in -d, -l, -r, -s, or -t. Usually, the last letter of the verb is dropped in order to add -sion and turn the verb into a noun.

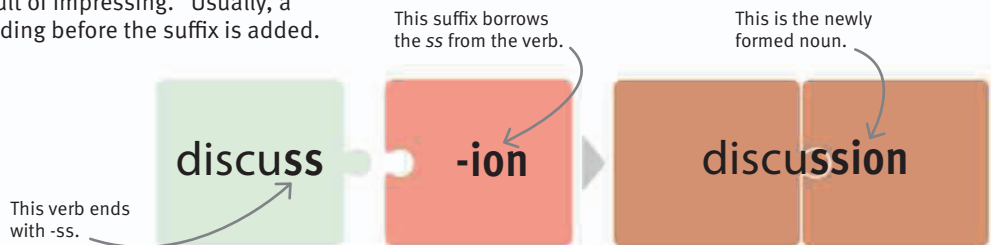


Words ending in -ssion

This suffix -ssion means “the result of.” For example, *impression* means “the result of impressing.” Usually, a verb needs to change its ending before the suffix is added.

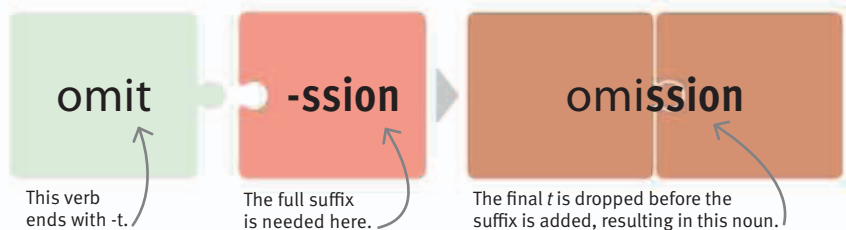
▷ Rule 1

If a verb ends in -ss, then just add -ion.



▷ Rule 2

If the verb ends with a -t, then remove it and add -ssion.



Unusual spellings

Some words that end with a “shun” sound do not follow the rules and just need to be learned. If unsure about the correct spelling, always check a dictionary.

Ending	Examples
-sian	Asian, Russian
-xion	complexion, crucifixion
-cion	coercion, suspicion
-cean	crustacean, ocean

The only words in which the “sh” sound at the start of the last syllable is spelled with the letters sh are *cushion* and *fashion*.